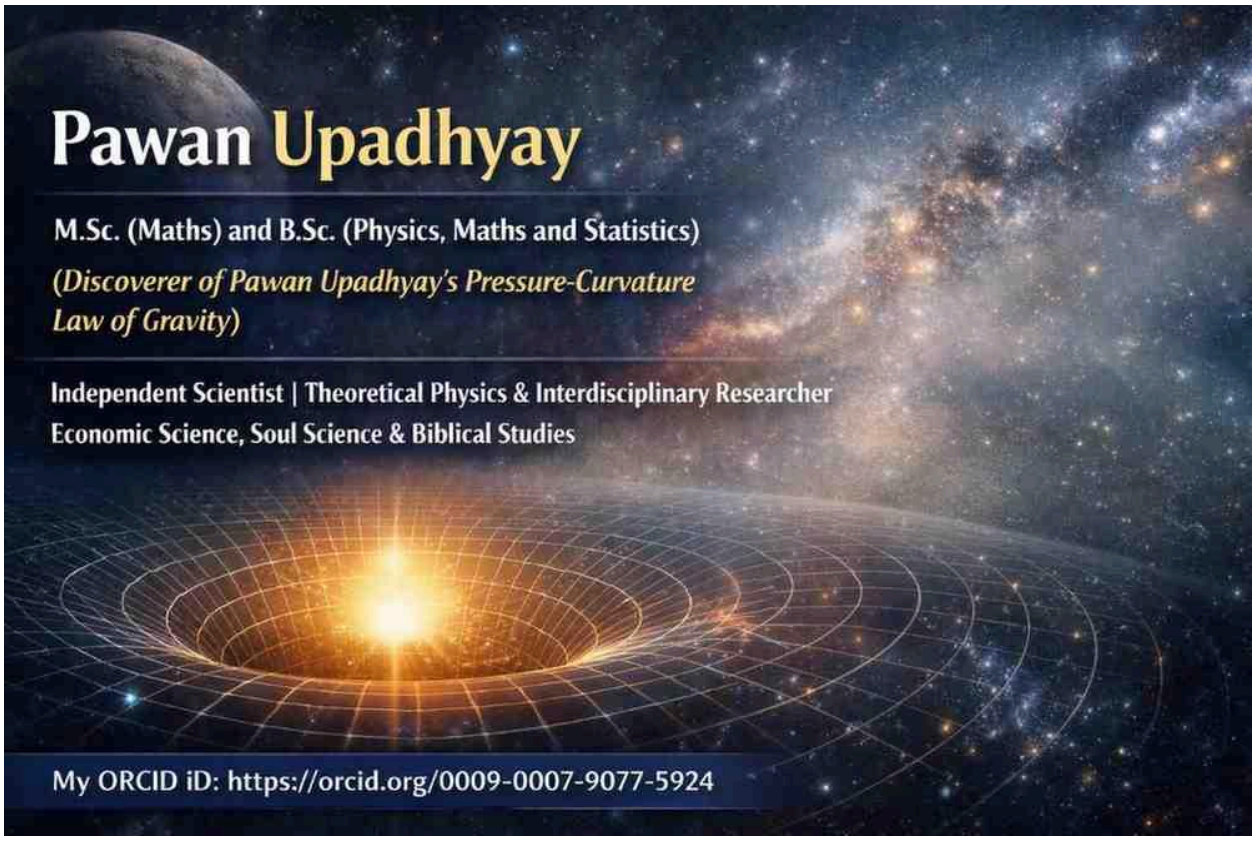
Truth, Created Reality, and Illusion:

A Christian Theological Study of Luke 1:4 and the Revelation of Jesus Christ

Author: Pawan Upadhyay
Affiliation: Independent Researcher and Independent Scientist
Email:pawanupadhyay28@hotmail.com
2nd Email: pawankanyakubj@gmail.com
ORCID iD: https://orcid.org/0009-0007-9077-5924



Abstract

This paper examines the Christian understanding of **truth, created reality, illusion, and eternity**, with particular attention to Luke 1:4 and its relationship to the Johannine declaration that “grace and truth came by Jesus Christ” (John 1:17). The study argues that Christianity should not be understood as teaching that creation itself is an illusion. Rather, created reality is

genuinely real because it comes from God, while illusion arises when the human mind misinterprets temporary created things as eternal, ultimate, or capable of providing absolute fulfillment.

The paper further examines greed, lust, physical beauty, bodily existence, possessions, and human thought as examples of the distinction between created reality and false interpretation. It then considers the New Testament identification of Jesus Christ with Truth, particularly John 1:1–14 and John 14:6. Finally, the paper connects this Christological understanding of Truth with the Christian doctrine of the Holy Trinity: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Keywords: Truth, Jesus Christ, Holy Trinity, creation, illusion, created reality, eternity, Luke 1:4, John 1:17, John 14:6, Christian theology.

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1. Introduction

The human search for truth raises a fundamental question: **What is ultimately real?**

Human beings encounter a world filled with physical objects, bodies, relationships, desires, beauty, possessions, institutions, and changing circumstances. These things appear real, yet they are also temporary. Human beings are born, live, age, and die. Possessions are acquired and lost. Physical beauty changes. Political powers rise and fall. Human thoughts and desires continually change.

This raises an important theological distinction between **created reality** and **illusion**.

Christian theology does not require the conclusion that the created world is unreal. On the contrary, Scripture begins with the affirmation:

“In the beginning God created heaven, and earth.”
— Genesis 1:1, Douay-Rheims

Creation therefore possesses genuine reality.

The problem arises when human beings attribute to created things qualities that belong properly to God—such as absolute permanence, ultimate security, or eternal fulfillment.

The central thesis of this paper is therefore:

Created reality is genuinely real, but the human mind can form illusions by treating temporary created realities as eternal or ultimate.

This distinction provides a framework for understanding Luke 1:4 and the New Testament proclamation that Truth has been revealed through Jesus Christ.

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2. Luke 1:4 and the Knowledge of Truth

Luke explains the purpose of his writing:

“That thou mayest know the verity of those words in which thou hast been instructed.”
— Luke 1:4, Douay-Rheims

The word **“verity”** signifies truth or certainty.

Luke's purpose is therefore epistemological as well as theological: he wants Theophilus to possess certainty concerning the Christian message.

Luke does not present the Christian proclamation merely as subjective religious feeling. He presents it as something concerning which the reader can attain knowledge.

Luke 1:4 therefore establishes an important principle:

Christian faith is concerned with Truth.

The question then becomes: **Where is this Truth ultimately revealed?**

The Gospel of John provides a central answer.

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3. Truth Came Through Jesus Christ

John 1:17 states:

“For the law was given by Moses, grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.”
— John 1:17, Douay-Rheims

This statement establishes a direct theological connection between **Truth and Jesus Christ**.

The Christian claim is not merely that Jesus was a teacher who possessed some knowledge of truth. The New Testament gives Christ a much more profound identity.

John writes:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”
— John 1:1, Douay-Rheims

And later:

“And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us.”
— John 1:14, Douay-Rheims

Consequently, Christian theology understands Jesus Christ as the eternal Word who entered human history.

Truth therefore did not merely arrive as an abstract proposition.

Truth was revealed through the person of Jesus Christ.

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4. Jesus Christ as the Truth

The most explicit statement occurs in John 14:6:

“I am the way, and the truth, and the life.”
— John 14:6, Douay-Rheims

This statement is central to Christian Christology.

Jesus does not merely say:

“I teach truth.”

He says:

“I am ... the truth.”

The distinction is substantial.

If Jesus merely taught truth, His teaching could be separated from His identity.

But if Christ is Truth, then the revelation of Truth is inseparable from the person of Christ.

This is consistent with John's opening identification of Christ as the eternal Word.

Thus, the New Testament presents a theological progression:

Luke 1:4 — know the truth.

John 1:17 — grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.

John 1:14 — the Word became flesh.

John 14:6 — Jesus is the Truth.

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5. Created Reality Is Not an Illusion

A significant theological clarification is necessary.

The claim that human beings experience illusion must not be confused with the claim that **creation itself is unreal**.

Christianity affirms creation.

The physical world is not simply an illusion.

The human body is not simply an illusion.

Other people are not simply illusions.

Nature is not simply an illusion.

Created things have genuine existence because God created them.

The distinction is therefore:

Reality belongs to the created thing; illusion belongs to the false interpretation of that thing.

For example, money is real.

But the belief that money can provide eternal security is an illusion.

The human body is real.

But the belief that the present mortal body is permanent is an illusion.

Beauty is real.

But the belief that physical beauty is eternal is an illusion.

The created object is not necessarily false.

The false claim concerning the object is the illusion.

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6. Temporality and Eternity

One of the most important biblical distinctions is between **temporal reality and eternal reality**.

Paul writes:

“For the things that are seen, are temporal; but the things that are not seen, are eternal.”
— 2 Corinthians 4:18, Douay-Rheims

The word **temporal** does not mean unreal.

A human life is temporal, but it is real.

A flower is temporal, but it is real.

A physical body is temporal, but it is real.

The earth is temporal in its present form, but it is real.

Therefore:

Temporary does not mean imaginary.

The theological error occurs when the temporary is mistaken for the eternal.

This distinction can be summarized as follows:

Temporal Created Reality	Eternal Reality
Created	Uncreated
Dependent	Ultimate source
Changing	Eternal
Finite	Infinite
Passing	Everlasting
Creation	Creator

God alone occupies the category of the eternal Creator.

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7. The Illusion of Greed

Greed demonstrates how the human mind can distort created reality.

Money and possessions are real.

The illusion lies in the belief that accumulation can provide ultimate fulfillment.

Greed creates an imagined future:

“If I possess enough, I will finally be completely secure.”

Yet possessions remain temporary.

Jesus warns:

“For what shall it profit a man, if he gain the whole world, and suffer the loss of his soul?”
— Mark 8:36, Douay-Rheims

The problem is therefore not the physical existence of possessions.

The problem is **making possessions ultimate**.

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8. The Illusion of Lust

Lust provides another example.

Human desire is a genuine human experience.

However, the mind may attach to desire a false promise:

“If this desire is satisfied, I will achieve lasting fulfillment.”

But physical satisfaction is temporary.

The desire changes.

The experience passes.

Another desire arises.

John therefore writes:

“And the world passeth away, and the concupiscence thereof: but he that doth the will of God, abideth for ever.”
— 1 John 2:17, Douay-Rheims

The desire is temporary.

God is eternal.

The illusion arises when temporary desire is treated as a source of permanent fulfillment.

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9. The Body: Created, Real, and Mortal

The human body occupies an important position in Christian theology.

It must not be treated as unreal merely because it is mortal.

The body is created by God and therefore possesses genuine dignity.

Yet the body is mortal.

Genesis states:

“For dust thou art, and into dust thou shalt return.”
— Genesis 3:19, Douay-Rheims

The Christian understanding therefore avoids two extremes.

The first is to treat the body as worthless.

The second is to treat the mortal body as eternal.

The Christian doctrine of resurrection further demonstrates that the body matters to God. Christianity does not deny bodily existence; rather, it teaches that mortality does not constitute the final destiny of human existence.

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10. Beauty and the Illusion of Permanence

Beauty belongs to created reality.

There is genuine beauty in nature and human appearance.

However, beauty is subject to change.

Peter writes:

“All flesh is as grass, and all the glory thereof as the flower of grass. The grass is withered, and the flower thereof is fallen away.”
— 1 Peter 1:24, Douay-Rheims

The biblical argument is not that beauty is unreal.

Rather:

Beauty is temporary.

The illusion is believing that temporary beauty possesses eternal permanence.

The theological lesson is therefore not rejection of beauty, but proper orientation toward it.

Beauty may be appreciated as a created good without being worshipped as an ultimate good.

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11. The Human Mind and the Problem of False Belief

The human mind is capable of thought, reasoning, imagination, memory, and judgment.

Yet the existence of a thought does not guarantee the truth of its content.

A person may think something false.

A person may imagine something nonexistent.

A person may misunderstand reality.

A person may believe that a temporary object will satisfy an eternal desire.

Therefore:

The reality of a thought as a mental event does not guarantee the truth of the thought's content.

This provides a philosophical basis for distinguishing **thought from Truth**.

Christian theology does not make the individual human mind the ultimate standard of reality.

Instead, the mind is called to conform itself to Truth.

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12. Creation and the Creator

The fundamental Christian distinction is between **Creator and creation**.

God is Creator.

Everything else is created.

God is eternal.

Creation is temporal.

God is uncreated.

Creation receives existence.

God does not depend upon creation.

Creation depends upon God.

Therefore, created reality cannot replace God as the ultimate object of worship.

The error of idolatry can be understood partly through this distinction: the creature is given the position that belongs to the Creator.

Thus:

The creature is real, but the creature is not God.

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13. The Holy Trinity and Eternal Truth

Christianity identifies the one God as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

Jesus commands:

“Going therefore, teach ye all nations; baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.”
— Matthew 28:19, Douay-Rheims

The Christian doctrine of the Trinity therefore distinguishes the eternal God from the created universe.

The Father is eternal.

The Son is eternal.

The Holy Spirit is eternal.

The creation is not eternal in the same manner.

This distinction is essential to the theological argument of this paper.

God is not merely another reality inside the universe.

God is the Creator upon whom created reality depends.

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14. Christ as the Revelation of the Eternal

The doctrine of the Incarnation provides the central connection between eternity and history.

John says:

“And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us.”
— John 1:14, Douay-Rheims

The eternal Word entered the temporal human world.

This can be expressed conceptually:

Eternal Word → becomes flesh → enters human history → reveals God and Truth.

Thus, Jesus Christ is the meeting point between the eternal and the temporal.

The Son remains divine while becoming truly human.

Christianity therefore sees Christ not simply as a human teacher but as the eternal Son revealed in human existence.

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15. Truth Versus Illusion

The theological distinction can now be stated precisely.

Created Reality

A thing that genuinely exists because God created it.

Illusion

A false perception, false belief, or false expectation concerning reality.

Temporal Reality

A created reality that exists within time and is subject to change.

Eternal Reality

That which belongs properly to God and does not pass away.

This produces the following framework:

Category	Meaning
God	Eternal, uncreated reality
Creation	Real, created, finite reality
Human thought	Real mental activity, but fallible
Illusion	False interpretation or expectation
Sinful attachment	Treating temporary goods as ultimate
Jesus Christ	Eternal Word made flesh; Truth revealed
Holy Trinity	One eternal God: Father, Son, and Holy Spirit

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16. The Christian Transformation of the Mind

The Christian response to illusion is not hatred of creation.

It is the **renewal of the mind**.

Paul writes:

“And be renewed in the spirit of your mind.”
— Ephesians 4:23, Douay-Rheims

The renewed mind learns to distinguish:

gift from God from **God Himself**;

temporary good from **ultimate good**;

desire from **fulfillment**;

appearance from **eternal Truth**;

creation from **Creator**.

The goal is not to stop perceiving the created world.

The goal is to perceive it **truthfully**.

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17. Discussion

The distinction between illusion and created reality has significant implications for Christian spirituality.

First, it prevents an overly simplistic claim that the material world is unreal. Christianity affirms creation as God's work.

Second, it explains why temporary things can become spiritually dangerous without being inherently evil. Money, beauty, bodily existence, and human relationships can be good created realities. The danger arises when they become ultimate.

Third, it establishes a hierarchy of reality:

God → Creator

Creation → dependent reality

Human interpretation → fallible understanding

Illusion → false interpretation

This hierarchy places human beings in a posture of humility.

The human mind is not the creator of Truth.

It is a creature seeking Truth.

The Christian claim is that this search finds its fulfillment in the revelation of God through Jesus Christ.

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18. Conclusion

Luke 1:4 expresses the purpose that the reader may know the **verity**, or truth, concerning the Christian message.

John 1:17 identifies Jesus Christ as the one through whom **grace and truth came**.

John 1:14 identifies Christ as the eternal Word made flesh.

John 14:6 records Jesus Christ's declaration:

“I am the way, and the truth, and the life.”

Taken together, these passages establish a central Christian theological claim:

Truth is not ultimately found in temporary created things. Truth is revealed by God through Jesus Christ.

Creation itself is not an illusion.

Creation is real because God created it.

The illusion occurs when the human mind confuses the temporary with the eternal, the created with the Creator, or a temporary good with ultimate fulfillment.

Greed can turn possessions into an illusion of permanent security.

Lust can turn temporary desire into an illusion of lasting fulfillment.

Beauty can become an illusion of permanence.

The mortal body can become an illusion of eternal identity.

Human thought can become an illusion when it assumes that whatever the mind believes must be true.

Christian faith calls the human person to see creation correctly.

Creation is real.

Creation is temporary.

The Creator is eternal.

Human thoughts are fallible.

Illusion is the false interpretation of reality.

Jesus Christ is the Truth revealed in the flesh.

And the eternal God revealed in Christian faith is:

Father, Son, and Holy Spirit.

The ultimate movement of Christian thought is therefore not from reality into unreality, but from **confused perception toward Truth**—from misunderstanding creation toward understanding the Creator, and from temporary things toward the Eternal God revealed in Jesus Christ.

Selected Biblical References

- Genesis 1:1
- Genesis 3:19
- Psalm 90:2
- Matthew 6:19–21
- Matthew 24:35
- Matthew 28:19
- Mark 8:36
- Luke 1:1–4
- John 1:1–18
- John 14:6–9
- 1 John 2:15–17
- 1 Peter 1:23–25
- 2 Corinthians 4:18
- Ephesians 4:23
- Hebrews 13:8

2nd Research Paper

Luke 1:4: A Word-by-Word Greek Research Study of Knowledge, Instruction, and Certainty

Abstract

Luke 1:4 provides an important statement concerning the purpose of the Third Gospel: that Theophilus may know the certainty of the things in which he has been instructed. This paper examines Luke 1:4 word by word from the Greek text, considering morphology, lexical meaning, syntax, translation, and theological significance. Particular attention is given to **ἵνα (*hina*)**, **ἐπιγνῷς (*epignōs*)**, **περὶ (*perí*)**, **ὧν (*hōn*)**, **κατηχήθης (*katēchēthēs*)**, **λόγων (*logōn*)**, **τὴν (*tēn*)**, and **ἀσφάλειαν (*asphaleian*)**.

The study argues that Luke 1:4 is fundamentally concerned with **certainty and reliability concerning previously received Christian instruction**. The Greek noun *asphaleia* is especially significant because it conveys the idea of certainty, security, firmness, or reliability. While some English translations use “truth” or “verity,” the immediate Greek emphasis is more specifically on the certainty or reliability of the Christian teaching received by Theophilus. The paper then examines how Luke 1:4 may be related to John 1:17 and John 14:6, where Jesus Christ is explicitly associated with truth. Such connections are theologically significant, but they should not be confused with the lexical meaning of *asphaleia* in Luke 1:4.

Keywords: Luke 1:4, Greek New Testament, *epignōs*, *katēcheō*, *logos*, *asphaleia*, truth, certainty, Jesus Christ, Theophilus, Gospel of Luke.

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1. Introduction

Luke 1:4 is one of the most important methodological statements in the opening of the Gospel according to Luke.

Luke begins by explaining that he has investigated the events concerning Jesus Christ and has written an orderly account for Theophilus. He then gives the purpose of this account:

“That thou mayest know the verity of those words in which thou hast been instructed.”
— Luke 1:4, Douay-Rheims

The Revised Standard Version renders the final thought:

“That you may know the truth concerning the things of which you have been informed.”

The Greek text, however, contains an important lexical distinction. The final noun is **ἀσφάλεια (*asphaleia*)**, whose semantic range includes **certainty, assurance, security, firmness, and reliability**.

Consequently, a word-by-word investigation is necessary before developing theological conclusions.

The central research question is:

What does Luke 1:4 actually communicate in its original Greek, and how does its meaning contribute to the Christian understanding of Truth revealed in Jesus Christ?

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2. Greek Text of Luke 1:4

The Greek text of Luke 1:4 is:

ἵνα ἐπιγνῷς περὶ ὧν κατηχήθης λόγων τὴν ἀσφάλειαν.

Transliteration:

hina epignōs peri hōn katēchēthēs logōn tēn asphaleian

A relatively literal rendering is:

“So that you may know the certainty concerning the words/things about which you were instructed.”

The word order of the Greek differs from natural English word order, so a strictly word-for-word English translation can sound unnatural. Nevertheless, examining the individual words reveals the structure of Luke's statement.

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3. Word One: ἵνα — *hina*

Greek

ἵνα

Transliteration

Hina

Basic meaning

So that; in order that; that.

Grammatical function

Hina introduces a purpose clause.

Luke has already explained that he is writing an orderly account. Verse 4 explains **why** he is writing it.

The structure is therefore:

Luke writes → so that → Theophilus may know.

This is important because Luke's writing has a defined purpose.

His purpose is not merely literary.

It is epistemological.

He wants his reader to **know**.

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4. Word Two: ἐπιγνῷς — *epignōs*

Greek

ἐπιγνῷς

Transliteration

Epignōs

Lexical form

ἐπιγινώσκω — *epiginōskō*

Meaning

Depending upon context:

- to know
- to recognize
- to come to know
- to know accurately or fully

Grammatical observation

The form is second-person singular and belongs to the subjunctive mood, functioning within the purpose clause introduced by *hina*.

Luke is addressing **Theophilus personally**.

The purpose is:

“that you may know.”

This is significant.

Luke does not merely want Theophilus to possess information.

He wants Theophilus to arrive at knowledge concerning what he has already been taught.

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5. Word Three: περὶ — *peri*

Greek

περὶ

Transliteration

Peri

Meaning

About, concerning, regarding.

This preposition identifies the subject concerning which Theophilus is to possess knowledge and certainty.

Luke therefore has a particular subject in view.

The certainty is not an abstract certainty about everything.

It concerns **the things about which Theophilus has received instruction**.

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6. Word Four: ὧν — *hōn*

Greek

ὧν

Transliteration

Hōn

Meaning

Of which; concerning which; the things which.

This is a relative pronoun.

It connects the present statement with the instruction Theophilus had already received.

Thus, Luke's Gospel does not begin from an assumption that Theophilus knows nothing.

Theophilus has already been instructed.

Luke's written account is intended to establish the reliability and certainty of that instruction.

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7. Word Five: κατηχήθης — *katēchēthēs*

Greek

κατηχήθης

Transliteration

Katēchēthēs

Lexical form

κατηχέω — *katēcheō*

Meaning

The verb can mean:

- to instruct
- to teach
- to inform
- to give oral instruction

It is the word from which the theological term **catechesis** is derived.

Grammatical significance

The form is second-person singular and passive.

The basic idea is:

“you were instructed.”

Theophilus had already received teaching.

Luke's account therefore serves as a written and orderly presentation related to previously received instruction.

This gives the verse an important pedagogical structure:

Instruction → written account → knowledge → certainty.

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8. Word Six: λόγων — *logōn*

Greek

λόγων

Transliteration

Logōn

Lexical form

λόγος — *logos*

Semantic range

Depending on context, *logos* may refer to:

- word
- statement
- saying
- message
- account
- matter
- teaching

The Douay-Rheims translates this context with the idea of **“words.”**

The RSV translates the larger expression as **“things.”**

This demonstrates an important principle of translation:

A Greek word cannot always be represented by exactly one English word.

Its meaning is determined partly by context.

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9. The Significance of λόγος in Luke and John

The word *logos* deserves special attention because it appears in both Luke 1:4 and John 1:1.

John famously writes:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”
— John 1:1, Douay-Rheims

Here *Logos* carries an extraordinarily profound Christological meaning.

However, scholarly interpretation should not automatically transfer John's full theological meaning of *Logos* into every occurrence of *logos* elsewhere in the New Testament.

In Luke 1:4, the immediate context concerns the **words, matters, or teachings** about which Theophilus had been instructed.

Therefore:

Luke 1:4 — *logōn* = words/teachings/matters in context.

John 1:1 — *Logos* = the eternal Word in John's Christology.

The passages can be connected theologically, but their lexical contexts should not be confused.

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10. Word Seven: τὴν — *tēn*

Greek

τὴν

Transliteration

Tēn

This is the feminine singular accusative form of the definite article:

"the."

It modifies the noun that follows:

ἀσφάλειαν — certainty/security/reliability.

Thus Luke is referring to a specific quality or condition that Theophilus is to know.

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11. Word Eight: ἀσφάλειαν — *asphaleian*

Greek

ἀσφάλειαν

Transliteration

Asphaleian

Lexical form

ἀσφάλεια — *asphaleia*

Meaning

The semantic range includes:

- certainty
- assurance
- security
- firmness
- reliability
- confidence

This is arguably the most important lexical word in Luke 1:4.

The Douay-Rheims uses:

“verity”

The RSV expresses the thought with:

“truth.”

But the Greek noun itself is more directly associated with **certainty, security, firmness, and reliability**.

Therefore, a literal theological observation is:

Luke's immediate emphasis is not simply the abstract concept of “truth,” but the **certainty and reliability of the Christian teaching received by Theophilus**.

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12. The Meaning of ἀσφάλεια

The word *asphaleia* can be understood through the conceptual idea of something being **firm or secure**.

Luke therefore wants Theophilus to possess something stable rather than uncertain.

The Gospel provides a foundation upon which Theophilus can confidently rely.

The theological implication is significant:

Christian instruction is not presented as an arbitrary human invention.

Luke writes so that the reader can know its reliability.

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13. The Complete Grammatical Structure

The verse can now be reconstructed:

ἵνα

so that

ἐπιγνῷς

you may know

περὶ ὧν

concerning which

κατηχήθης

you were instructed

λόγων

words/teachings/matters

τὴν ἀσφάλειαν

the certainty/reliability

Therefore:

“So that you may know the certainty concerning the things about which you were instructed.”

This captures the principal grammatical and lexical meaning.

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14. Douay-Rheims and RSV Compared

Greek	Douay-Rheims	RSV
ἵνα	that	that
ἐπιγνῷς	thou mayest know	you may know
περὶ ὧν	of those	concerning the things
κατηχήθης	hast been instructed	have been informed
λόγων	words	—
ἀσφάλειαν	verity	truth

The translations emphasize different aspects of the Greek.

The Douay-Rheims preserves the traditional term **“verity.”**

The RSV communicates the idea more naturally as **“truth.”**

The Greek *asphaleia*, however, gives particular weight to **certainty and reliability**.

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15. Luke 1:4 and Truth

It is therefore reasonable to connect Luke 1:4 with the Christian theme of Truth.

However, precision is important.

Luke 1:4 does **not literally contain the Greek noun ἀλήθεια (*aletheia*)**, the ordinary Greek word for “truth.”

Instead, it contains **ἀσφάλεια (*asphaleia*)**, emphasizing certainty or reliability.

This distinction matters for serious biblical research.

Therefore, the strongest scholarly formulation is:

Luke 1:4 concerns certainty concerning the truth or reliability of the Christian teaching received by Theophilus.

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16. Connection with John 1:17

John 1:17 states:

“For the law was given by Moses, grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.”

Here John explicitly uses the Greek concept of **truth**.

The theological relationship can therefore be stated carefully:

Luke 1:4 emphasizes knowing with certainty.

John 1:17 explicitly associates grace and truth with Jesus Christ.

The two passages therefore complement one another within Christian theology.

Luke addresses the **certainty of the Gospel message**.

John identifies **Jesus Christ with the revelation of grace and truth**.

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17. Connection with John 14:6

Jesus declares:

“I am the way, and the truth, and the life.”
— John 14:6, Douay-Rheims

Here the concept becomes explicitly Christological.

Jesus does not merely say that He teaches truth.

He identifies Himself as **the Truth**.

Therefore, the broader New Testament theological movement can be expressed as:

Luke 1:4 — certainty concerning the Christian message.

John 1:17 — truth came through Jesus Christ.

John 1:14 — the Word became flesh.

John 14:6 — Jesus is the Truth.

This progression provides a strong foundation for a Christian theology of Truth.

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18. Truth and Created Reality

The distinction between Truth and created reality must also be maintained carefully.

Christianity does not teach that creation is an illusion.

Genesis affirms:

“In the beginning God created heaven, and earth.”

Creation is therefore real.

But creation is not eternal in the same sense as God.

The world changes.

Human beings change.

Bodies age.

Beauty fades.

Possessions pass from one person to another.

Human achievements become history.

Thus, the created world is **real but temporal**.

19. Illusion as Misinterpretation

Theologically, an illusion can therefore be understood as a false interpretation of something real.

For example:

Created Reality

Money exists.

Illusion

Money will provide eternal security.

Created Reality

The body exists.

Illusion

The present body is permanent.

Created Reality

Beauty exists.

Illusion

Physical beauty will never disappear.

Created Reality

Pleasure exists.

Illusion

Pleasure can provide eternal fulfillment.

Created Reality

Human thought exists.

Illusion

Every human thought must be true.

This distinction prevents us from confusing **creation with illusion**.

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20. The Eternal and the Temporal

The biblical worldview distinguishes the temporal from the eternal.

Paul writes:

“For the things that are seen, are temporal; but the things that are not seen, are eternal.”
— 2 Corinthians 4:18, Douay-Rheims

The visible world is therefore not described as nonexistent.

It is described as **temporal**.

This is crucial.

Temporary does not mean unreal.

The human body is real, but mortal.

The earth is real, but temporal.

Human life is real, but passing.

The illusion occurs when the human mind treats these realities as though they were eternal.

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21. Christ and Eternal Truth

The Christian claim concerning Jesus Christ goes beyond His being a moral teacher.

John identifies Him as the eternal Word:

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.”
— John 1:1

And:

“And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us.”
— John 1:14

Christian theology therefore understands Christ as the eternal Word entering human history.

This provides the theological basis for connecting Jesus Christ with eternal Truth.

The Truth is not merely an idea.

The Truth is revealed in the person of Christ.

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22. The Holy Trinity

The Christian understanding of Jesus Christ ultimately leads into Trinitarian theology.

Jesus commands baptism:

“In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost.”
— Matthew 28:19, Douay-Rheims

Christianity therefore confesses:

One God.

Father.

Son.

Holy Spirit.

The eternal God is distinguished from everything created.

The Father is not a creature.

The Son is not a creature.

The Holy Spirit is not a creature.

God is eternal.

Creation is dependent upon God.

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23. Research Finding

The word-by-word examination of Luke 1:4 produces several significant findings.

Finding 1

Luke's purpose is expressed through **ἵνα**, indicating that his writing has a specific intended result.

Finding 2

ἐπιγνῷς emphasizes that Theophilus is to arrive at knowledge or recognition.

Finding 3

κατηχήθης establishes that Theophilus had already received instruction.

Finding 4

λόγων refers contextually to words, teachings, matters, or accounts concerning which instruction had been received.

Finding 5

ἀσφάλεια is the key term expressing certainty, firmness, reliability, or assurance.

Finding 6

Luke 1:4 therefore emphasizes the **certainty and reliability of the Christian message**.

Finding 7

The explicit identification of Jesus Christ with Truth comes more directly from Johannine texts such as John 1:17 and John 14:6.

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24. Conclusion

Luke 1:4 is a foundational passage for understanding the relationship between **Christian instruction, knowledge, certainty, and Truth**.

Its Greek structure can be summarized:

ἵνα — so that
ἐπιγνῷς — you may know
περὶ ὧν — concerning which
κατηχήθης — you were instructed
λόγων — words/teachings
τὴν ἀσφάλειαν — the certainty/reliability

The verse therefore communicates:

Luke writes so that Theophilus may know with certainty the reliability of the Christian teaching he has received.

This certainty is not presented as an illusion created by the human mind.

It concerns the Christian proclamation centered upon Jesus Christ.

When Luke 1:4 is read alongside John 1:17, John 1:14, and John 14:6, a broader theological picture emerges:

Luke calls the reader to certainty.

John declares that grace and Truth came through Jesus Christ.

John identifies Jesus as the eternal Word made flesh.

Jesus declares, "I am ... the truth."

Thus, within Christian theology, the ultimate movement is from **human uncertainty toward divine revelation**, from **false interpretation toward Truth**, and from **temporary created reality toward the eternal Creator**.

The created world is real.

The human mind is real but fallible.

Illusion arises when temporary things are mistaken for eternal things.

And the Christian proclamation is that eternal Truth has been revealed in **Jesus Christ**, the Word made flesh.

Luke 1:4 therefore stands as an invitation to move from instruction to knowledge, from knowledge to certainty, and from certainty toward the Truth revealed by God in Jesus Christ.